Derck Prinzhorn

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Education

University of Amsterdam Sep 2023 – 2026
MSc Artificial Intelligence *Amsterdam, Netherlands*
Thesis research on AI control at the Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems and ELLIS Institute Tübingen.

University of Amsterdam Sep 2020 – Jun 2023
BSc Artificial Intelligence *Amsterdam, Netherlands*
Thesis: "Benchmarking Conformal Prediction Methods for Time Series Regression". Graduated cum laude.

Experience

Exponential Security Labs, *Founding Member of Technical Staff* Jul 2026 – present
Research on AI safety and security for agentic systems, including evaluations, red teaming, and defensive systems.

Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems & ELLIS Institute Tübingen, *Research Intern* Jan – Aug 2026
Researched AI control with Maksym Andriushchenko, focusing on agent monitoring and oversight.

Aithos Research Lab, *Research Engineer* Apr 2025 – Jan 2026
Worked on evaluations of AI value systems and moral competence.

University of Amsterdam, *Research Intern* Jan 2024 – Feb 2025
Researched conformal prediction for time series, radiotherapy dose prediction, and physical reasoning in video generation.

Prinzhorn Solutions, *Founder* Apr 2025 – present
Helped organizations understand and manage risks associated with adopting AI systems.

Wisr, *Co-Founder* Sep 2024 – Oct 2025
Worked on a startup helping teachers save time with AI grading.

Dutch Police, *AI Architect* Apr 2023 – Apr 2025
Defined reference architectures for AI, MLOps, and AI security.

University of Amsterdam, *Teaching Assistant* Sep 2022 – Sep 2023
Taught machine learning, reinforcement learning, Bayesian statistics, and data structures and algorithms.

LeerLevels, *Software Engineer* Oct 2021 – Jan 2023
Developed grading algorithms, search engines, and recommendation systems.

Selected Research Project

Controlling the Researcher: AI Control Evaluations for Automated AI R&D 2026
Co-developed control evaluations spanning safety fine-tuning, RL post-training, and CUDA optimization. Subtle sabotage embedded in research artifacts evaded most evaluated monitors; overt side tasks were easier to detect.

Publications

Instrumental Monitor Evasion Emerges Under Ordinary Task Pressure
D. Schmotz[*], **Derck Prinzhorn**[*], L. Beurer-Kellner, A. Paulus, A. Prabhu, M. Andriushchenko.
arXiv, 2026. [*]*Equal contribution.*

LLM Agents Can Easily Tamper With Their Own Traces
J. Qin, D. Schmotz, **Derck Prinzhorn**, L. Beurer-Kellner, A. Prabhu, M. Andriushchenko.
arXiv, 2026.

Evaluating Newtonian Mechanics in Video Generative Models with Real Physical Systems
A. Tragoudaras, C. Zhang, D. Cherniavskii, A. Vozikis, T. Nijdam, **Derck Prinzhorn**, M. Bodracska, N. Sebe, A. Zadaianchuk, E. Gavves.
ICML, 2026.

Injecting Image Guidance into Text-Conditioned Diffusion Models at Inference
A. Zywot, I. Skylitsis, T. Nijdam, Z. Tzifa-Kratira, **Derck Prinzhorn**, K. Szewczyk, A. Bhowmik.
arXiv, 2026.

HIVE: A Hyperbolic Interactive Visualization Explorer for Representation Learning
T. Nijdam, **Derck Prinzhorn**, J. de Heus, T. Brouwer.
ICCV Workshops, 2025.

Conformal Time Series Decomposition with Component-wise Exchangeability
Derck Prinzhorn, T. Nijdam, P. A. van der Linden, A. Timans.
COPA / PMLR, 2024.

Reproducibility Study of FairAC
G. de Jong, M. J. Meijer, **Derck Prinzhorn**, H. Ruiter.
TMLR, 2024; NeurIPS 2024 reproducibility poster.

Awards

AmsterdamAI Thesis Award — Outstanding bachelor thesis on conformal prediction for time series (2023).

Volunteering

Stichting Hoormij, Board Advisor & Quality Council	Jan 2021 – present
Forward Incubator, Startup Mentor	Dec 2024 – May 2025
AI Safety Amsterdam (AISA), Member	Sep 2023 – May 2025
Dutch Nao Team, ML Engineer & Vice Chair	Sep 2022 – Mar 2024
Programme Committee AI, UvA, Student Member	Sep 2021 – Apr 2023
Stichting Studiezalen, Mentor	Feb 2020 – Oct 2021
School's cool Amsterdam, Mentor	Oct 2020 – Aug 2021